

CRISTHIAN MOLINA

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Urbana–Champaign

PhD in Economics

Fields: Labor Economics, Economics of Education

ILLINOIS, UNITED STATES

2026

Université de Lorraine

Master en Ingénierie des Systèmes Complexes

NANCY, FRANCE

2015

Universidad de Santiago

Bachelor and Master of Engineering Sciences, Industrial Engineering

SANTIAGO, CHILE

2013–2016

POSITIONS

Northwestern University

Postdoctoral Fellow

School of Education and Social Policy

EVANSTON, IL

June 2026 – present

RESEARCH

Working Papers

“Signaling Quality or Gaming the System? Evidence from College-Major Accreditation”

with Rocío Valdebenito

“When Rankings Reward Age: Admissions Formula and the College Application Gap”

“When Certification Hurts: Accreditation Signals and Graduate Wages”

Work in Progress

“Grading the Graders: Competition and Quality Inflation in Certification Markets”

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor

Microeconomic Principles

Introduction to Economics

Intermediate Microeconomics

Universidad de Santiago de Chile

Spring 2018 to Fall 2018

Spring 2019

Spring 2019

Teaching Assistant

Microeconomic Principles

Intermediate Microeconomic Theory

University of Illinois

Fall 2020 to Fall 2021

Spring 2023 to Spring 2025

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Dr. Joshua Shea

Dr. Alex Bartik

Dr. Adam Osman

Dr. Jorge Lemus

Dr. Rebecca Thornton

Accreditation Consultant

Department of Industrial Engineering

University of Illinois Department of Economics

Summer 2025, Fall 2025

Summer 2024

Spring 2024

Summer 2023, Spring 2024

Summer 2021, Spring 2022

Universidad de Santiago de Chile

2016–2018

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP) 51 st Annual Conference	2026
Illinois Economic Association, 54 th annual meeting	2025
University of Illinois, Economics Department, Applied Micro Seminars	2021-2025

AWARDS & HONORS

Kleiner Labor Economics Prize, University of Illinois	2023
List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Their Students, University of Illinois	2023, 2024, 2025

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Referee for *Pakistan Journal of Applied Economics*

SKILLS

Technical Stata , LaTeX , Python, R.

Languages: Spanish (*native*), English (*fluent*), French (*intermediate*).

REFERENCES

Jorge Lemus Associate Professor of Economics <i>University of Illinois</i> jalemus@illinois.edu	Alex Bartik Assistant Professor of Economics <i>University of Illinois</i> abartik@illinois.edu	Russell Weinstein Associate Professor <i>School of Labor & Employment Relations</i> <i>University of Illinois</i> weinst@illinois.edu	Joshua Shea Assistant Professor of Economics <i>University of Illinois</i> jkcshea@illinois.edu
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